



# Education Annual Report Update

2024-25

This publication is available online at <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/1927-4610>

This publication is issued under the Open Government Licence – Alberta  
(<http://open.alberta.ca/licence>).

Education and Childcare, Government of Alberta | Education Annual Report Update 2024–2025

©2025 Government of Alberta | December 2025 | ISBN 978-1-4601-6398-6 | ISSN 1927-4610

---

# Table of Contents

Results Analysis .....2

    Discussion and Analysis of Results.....2

    Outcome One .....2

Performance Measure Methodology..... 14

## Results Analysis

### Discussion and Analysis of Results

This annual report update provides analysis of Alberta students' results on Language Arts and Mathematics provincial achievement tests administered in the 2024-25 school year.

Results for the 2020-21 provincial achievement tests are not available in this report due to the impact of COVID-19-related learning disruptions. Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the wildfires in 2022-23, by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22, and by security breaches that occurred over the last few days of the 2021-22 provincial achievement test administration window. To maintain the validity of provincial results, student data most likely impacted by these security breaches has been excluded from the overall results.

In 2024-25, Alberta Education and Childcare continued to develop, administer and mark provincial achievement tests and diploma examinations to report student achievement, ensure standards are maintained and assist schools, school authorities and the province in monitoring and improving student learning. Grade 6 provincial achievement tests in English Language Arts and Literature and Mathematics were administered in 2024-25. Results are reported in the update as supplementary information.

In 2024-25, overall provincial achievement test results comprising Grades 6 and 9 Language Arts and Mathematics cannot be calculated due to new curriculum being piloted or implemented for Grade 6 subjects. As a result, Grade 9 provincial achievement test results for Language Arts and Mathematics at overall subject levels are assessed against targets and historical results.

The targets for 2024-25 were set based on historical data up to 2022-23. These targets were published as part of the performance measures in the 2024-27 Education and Childcare business plan. Caution should be exercised when assessing results relative to targets.

### Outcome One

#### Alberta's students are successful

Alberta Education and Childcare provides leadership, direction and oversight in the delivery of a student-centred Early Childhood Services to Grade 12 education system that serves Alberta's children and students. In 2024-25, the ministry continued to update and implement provincial curriculum to provide Alberta students with foundational knowledge and essential skills needed for future success. The ministry monitors student progress through the administration of provincial assessments to ensure that Alberta's Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system remains accountable and responsive to students' needs. Alberta Education and Childcare also collaborates with other ministry partners to expand mental health and well-being supports in schools and communities to empower students with the necessary resources to thrive in learning and life.

## **Overall Achievement Test Results in Grade 9 Language Arts and Mathematics**

### ***Rationale***

- Overall student achievement of standards on provincial achievement tests is a sound indicator of whether elementary and junior high students are achieving high standards in Language Arts and in Mathematics, an important outcome for Alberta's Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system.

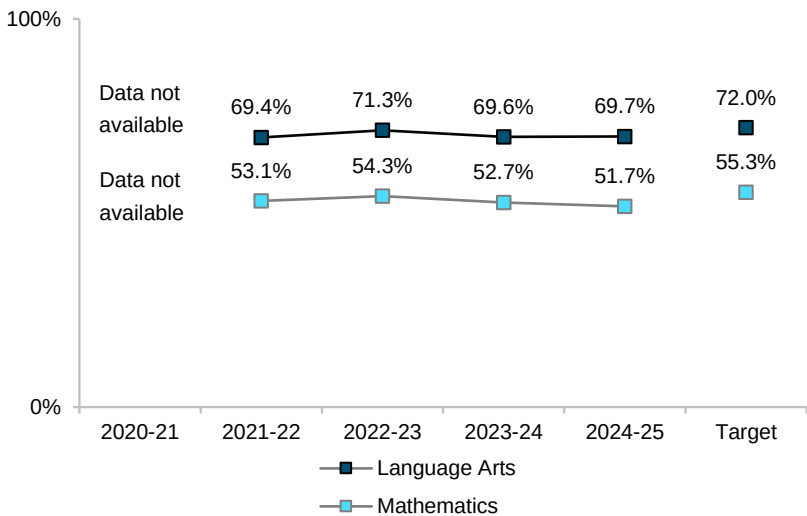
### ***Target***

- The targets for the overall Grade 9 Language Arts result and the overall Mathematics result were not met.

### ***Discussion***

- In 2024-25, 69.7 per cent of students achieved the acceptable standard in overall Grade 9 Language Arts, while 51.7 per cent of students achieved the acceptable standard in overall Grade 9 Mathematics (Chart 1.c).
- Overall results in Grade 9 Language Arts are calculated as an average of the results in the following four subjects weighted by the number of individuals that were enrolled:
  - English Language Arts 9
  - French Language Arts 9
  - Français 9
  - English Language Arts 9 (Knowledge and Employability)
- Overall results in Grade 9 Mathematics are calculated as an average of the results in the following two subjects weighted by the number of individuals that were enrolled:
  - Mathematics 9
  - Mathematics 9 (Knowledge and Employability)
- Due to COVID-19 related learning disruptions, results are not available for the 2020-21 school year.
- From 2021-22 to 2024-25, the overall proportion of Grade 9 students achieving the acceptable standard in Language Arts has remained stable.
- From 2021-22 to 2024-25, the overall proportion of Grade 9 students achieving the acceptable standard in Mathematics has declined.

Chart 1.c: Overall Percentages of Students Who Achieved Standards on Grade 9 Provincial Achievement Tests in Language Arts and Mathematics



Source: Alberta Education and Childcare

Notes:

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the provincial achievement tests were impacted by COVID-19-related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22.
- Student data most likely affected by the provincial achievement test security breach of 2021-22 has been excluded from the overall 2021-22 results. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Until the Grade 6 curriculum renewals are complete and provincial achievement tests resume for students, the ministry will publish Grade 9 Language Arts and Mathematics results as an indicator of student achievement related to the programs of study.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Overall Grade 9 Language Arts results are a weighted average based on total enrolment in Grade 9 Language Arts courses.
- Overall Grade 9 Mathematics results are a weighted average based on total enrolment in Grade 9 Mathematics courses.
- See Endnote A, page 14, for information on assessing results relative to targets and results over time.
- See Endnote B, Provincial Achievement Tests, pages 16-17.

### Discussion:

- From 2021-22 to 2024-25, the overall participation rate for students taking Grade 9 Language Arts and Mathematics provincial achievement tests has increased over time (Table 1.c)

**Table 1.c: Participation Rates for Grade 9 Language Arts and Mathematics Provincial Achievement Tests (in percentages)**

| Subject                                             |                    | 2020-21 | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 | 2024-25 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| Language Arts                                       |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
| Grade 9                                             |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
| English Language Arts                               | Data not available |         | 82      | 84      | 83      | 85      |
| English Language Arts (Knowledge and Employability) |                    |         | 75      | 70      | 72      | 75      |
| French Language Arts                                |                    |         | 93      | 94      | 94      | 95      |
| Français                                            |                    |         | 93      | 94      | 94      | 97      |
| Overall Grade 9 Language Arts                       |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
|                                                     | Data not available |         | 82.3    | 84.2    | 83.3    | 85.2    |
| Mathematics                                         |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
| Grade 9                                             |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
| Mathematics                                         | Data not available |         | 83      | 84      | 85      | 85      |
| Mathematics (Knowledge & Employability)             |                    |         | 82      | 82      | 81      | 82      |
| Overall Grade 9 Mathematics                         |                    |         |         |         |         |         |
|                                                     | Data not available |         | 83.0    | 83.9    | 84.9    | 85.3    |

**Source:** Alberta Education and Childcare

### Notes:

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the provincial achievement tests were affected by COVID-19 related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22.
- Student data most likely impacted by the provincial achievement test security breach of 2021-22 has been excluded from the 2021-22 overall results. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Knowledge and Employability courses are designed for students who meet enrolment criteria and learn best through experiences that integrate essential and employability skills in occupational contexts.

*Performance Measure 1.c:*

**Language Arts and Mathematics Achievement Test Results by Individual Subject for Students in Grade 9**

***Rationale***

- Student results on provincial achievement tests in each grade and subject provide detailed information on whether junior high students are achieving standards in Language Arts and in Mathematics, an important outcome for Alberta's Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system.

***Target***

- Targets for individual Language Arts and Mathematics subject results were not set in the 2024-27 business plan.

***Discussion***

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by COVID-19-related learning disruptions.
- Based on the previous three-year average and 2024-25 data, the proportion of Grade 9 students achieving the acceptable standard has remained stable over time for English Language Arts 9, English Language Arts 9 (Knowledge and Employability), French Language Arts 9 and Français 9 (Table 1.c.1).
- Based on the previous three-year average and 2024-25 data, the proportion of Grade 9 students achieving the acceptable standard has decreased over time for Mathematics 9 and Mathematics 9 (Knowledge and Employability) (Table 1.c.2).
- Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the wildfires in 2022-23, by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22, and by the security breaches that occurred over the last few days of the 2021-22 provincial achievement test administration window. Student data most likely impacted by these security breaches has been excluded from the overall results. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.

**Table 1.c.1: Percentages of Students in Grade 9 Who Achieved the Acceptable Standard on Provincial Achievement Tests in Language Arts (in percentages)**

|                                                        |                       |         |         |         | Previous<br>3-year<br>average |         | Target<br>2024-25 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------------------|---------|-------------------|
| Subject                                                | 2020-21               | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 |                               | 2024-25 |                   |
| Language Arts                                          |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
| Grade 9                                                |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
| English Language Arts                                  | Data not<br>available | 69.6    | 71.4    | 69.5    | 70.2                          | 69.8    |                   |
| English Language Arts<br>(Knowledge and Employability) |                       | 50.5    | 50.2    | 49.6    | 50.1                          | 47.4    |                   |
| French Language Arts                                   |                       | 73.5    | 76.1    | 76.6    | 75.4                          | 75.2    |                   |
| Français                                               |                       | 80.0    | 81.6    | 83.1    | 81.5                          | 84.8    |                   |
| Overall Grade 9 Language Arts                          |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
|                                                        | Data not<br>available | 69.4    | 71.3    | 69.6    | 70.1                          | 69.7    | 72.0              |

**Source:** Alberta Education and Childcare

**Notes:**

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the provincial achievement tests was affected by COVID-19 related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22.
- Student data most likely impacted by the provincial achievement test security breach of 2021-22 has been excluded from the 2021-22 overall results. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Knowledge and Employability courses are designed for students who meet enrolment criteria and learn best through experiences that integrate essential and employability skills in occupational contexts.
- See Endnote A, page 14, for information on assessing results relative to targets, and results over time.
- See Endnote B, Provincial Achievement Tests, pages 16-17.

**Table 1.c.2: Percentages of Students in Grade 9 Who Achieved the Acceptable Standard on Provincial Achievement Tests in Mathematics** *(in percentages)*

|                                              |                       |         |         |         | Previous<br>3-year<br>average | 2024-25 | Target<br>2024-25 |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------------------|---------|-------------------|
| Subject                                      | 2020-21               | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 |                               |         |                   |
| Mathematics                                  |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
| Grade 9                                      |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
| Mathematics                                  | Data not<br>available | 53.0    | 54.4    | 52.7    | 53.3                          | 51.7    |                   |
| Mathematics<br>(Knowledge and Employability) |                       | 55.3    | 52.7    | 52.2    | 53.4                          | 49.7    |                   |
| Overall Mathematics                          |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |                   |
|                                              | Data not<br>available | 53.1    | 54.3    | 52.7    | 53.4                          | 51.7    | 55.3              |

**Source:** Alberta Education and Childcare**Notes:**

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by COVID-19 related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Participation in the provincial achievement tests was impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22.
- Student data most likely impacted by the provincial achievement test security breach of 2021-22 has been excluded from the 2021-22 overall results. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Knowledge and Employability courses are designed for students who meet enrolment criteria and learn best through experiences that integrate essential and employability skills in occupational contexts.
- See Endnote A, page 14, for information on assessing results relative to targets, and results over time.
- See Endnote B, Provincial Achievement Tests, pages 16-17.

Supplementary Information

Grade 6 Achievement Test Results in English Language Arts and Literature and Mathematics

Percentages of Students Who Achieved the Acceptable Standard in Grade 6 Provincial Achievement Tests in English Language Arts and Literature and Mathematics *(in percentages)*

| Subject                              | 2020-21             | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 | 2024-25 |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| Grade 6                              |                     |         |         |         |         |
| English Language Arts and Literature | Data not applicable |         |         |         | 69.1    |
| Mathematics                          |                     |         |         |         | 53.1    |

Source: Alberta Education and Childcare

Notes:

- In the 2024-25 school year, Grade 6 provincial achievement tests were administered for English Language Arts and Literature and Mathematics.
- Due to the Kindergarten to Grade 6 curriculum renewal, 2024-25 is the first year of tests that reflect the new curriculum. Current year results are not comparable to results from previous years that were based on the old curriculum.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- See Endnote B, Provincial Achievement Tests, pages 16-17.

*Supplementary Information*

**Overall Diploma Examination Results in Language Arts and Mathematics**

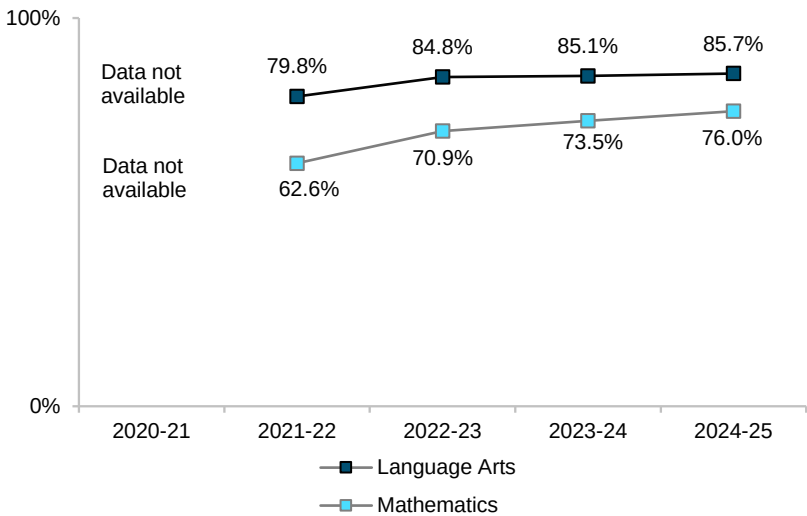
***Rationale***

- Student results on diploma examinations are a solid indicator of whether high school students are achieving high standards in Language Arts and Mathematics.
- The Language Arts diploma examination measure is an aggregate of four Language Arts courses. This reflects a focus on fundamental reading and writing skills, which are important outcomes for Alberta's Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system.
- The Mathematics diploma examination measure is an aggregate of two courses. This measure reflects a focus on the development of mathematical reasoning and problem-solving skills, which are important outcomes for Alberta's Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system.

***Discussion***

- The Language Arts measure is an average of the results in the following four subjects, weighted by the total number of individuals who wrote each of the exams:
  - English Language Arts 30-1
  - English Language Arts 30-2
  - French Language Arts 30-1
  - Français 30-1
- The Mathematics measure is an average of the results in the following two subjects, weighted by the total number of individuals that wrote each of the exams:
  - Mathematics 30-1
  - Mathematics 30-2
- Due to COVID-19 related learning disruptions, results are not available for the 2020-21 school year.
- From 2021-22 to 2024-25, the overall proportion of students achieving the acceptable standard in Language Arts has increased over time.
- From 2021-22 to 2024-25, the overall proportion of students achieving the acceptable standard in Mathematics has increased over time.

Overall Percentages of Students Who Achieved Standards on Diploma Examinations in Language Arts and Mathematics



Source: Alberta Education and Childcare

Notes:

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in the diploma examinations were impacted by COVID-19-related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- Overall results for Language Arts are a weighted average of results for the four Language Arts subjects.
- Overall results for Mathematics are a weighted average of results for the two Mathematics subjects.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- See Endnote A, page 14, for information on assessing results over time.
- See Endnote B, Diploma Examinations, pages 17-18.

Discussion:

- Based on the previous three-year average and 2024-25 data, the proportion of students achieving the acceptable standard has increased over time for English Language Arts 30-1 and English Language Arts 30-2.
- The number of students writing French Language Arts 30-1 and Français 30-1 exams was too small to make comparisons over time.

Percentages of Students Who Achieved the Acceptable Standard in Diploma Examinations in Language Arts (in percentages)

|                            |                       |         |         |         | Previous<br>3-year<br>average |         |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------------------|---------|
| Subject                    | 2020-21               | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 |                               | 2024-25 |
| Language Arts              |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |
| Grade 9                    |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |
| English Language Arts 30-1 | Data not<br>available | 78.8    | 83.7    | 84.2    | 82.2                          | 85.3    |
| English Language Arts 30-2 |                       | 80.8    | 86.2    | 85.7    | 84.2                          | 85.6    |
| French Language Arts 30-1  |                       | 91.9    | 93.1    | 95.3    | 93.4                          | 94.7    |
| Français 30-1              |                       | 98.8    | 99.2    | 99.4    | 99.1                          | 99.4    |
| Overall Language Arts      |                       |         |         |         |                               |         |
|                            | Data not<br>available | 79.8    | 84.8    | 85.1    | 83.2                          | 85.7    |

Source: Alberta Education and Childcare

Notes:

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in diploma examinations were affected by COVID-19 related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Overall results for Language Arts are a weighted average of results for the four Language Arts subjects.
- Participation in diploma examinations was affected by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- See Endnote A, page 14 for information on assessing results relative to targets and results over time.
- See Endnote B, Diploma Examinations, pages 17-18.

Discussion:

- Based on the previous three-year average and 2024-25 data, the proportion of students achieving the acceptable standard has increased over time for Mathematics 30-1 and Mathematics 30-2.

Percentages of Students Who Achieved the Acceptable Standard in Diploma Examinations in Mathematics (in percentages)

|                     |                    |         |         |         | Previous 3-year average |         |
|---------------------|--------------------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------------|---------|
| Subject             | 2020-21            | 2021-22 | 2022-23 | 2023-24 |                         | 2024-25 |
| Mathematics         |                    |         |         |         |                         |         |
| Grade 9             |                    |         |         |         |                         |         |
| Mathematics 30-1    | Data not available | 63.6    | 70.8    | 75.4    | 69.9                    | 77.8    |
| Mathematics 30-2    |                    | 61.5    | 71.1    | 70.9    | 67.8                    | 73.6    |
| Overall Mathematics |                    |         |         |         |                         |         |
|                     | Data not available | 62.6    | 70.9    | 73.5    | 69.0                    | 76.0    |

Source: Alberta Education and Childcare

Notes:

- Results for the 2020-21 school year are not available as participation in diploma examinations were affected by COVID-19 related learning disruptions. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- The percentages of students who achieved the acceptable standard include the students who achieved the standard of excellence.
- Overall results for Mathematics are a weighted average of results for the two Mathematics subjects.
- Participation in diploma examinations was affected by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-21 and 2021-22. Caution should be exercised when interpreting the results over time.
- See Endnote A, page 14 for information on assessing results over time.
- See Endnote B, Diploma Examinations, pages 17-18.

## Performance Measure Methodology

### Endnote A: Technical Notes

#### Assessing Results Relative to Targets

Performance targets set expectations for results within specific time frames and are the basis for planning improvements and assessing results that are within the sphere of influence of the ministry. They are an important way to gauge whether the education system is improving or falling behind in obtaining desired results in key areas. Targets clearly establish desired levels of performance better than recent performance, to be attained within a specific time frame. Targets are quantifiable and expressed in numerical terms, such as percentages or ratios. They are used as a key tool to drive, measure, improve and manage performance.

For measures based on achievement tests, a one-sample Chi-square statistical test is used to determine whether the result is significantly different from the target and whether the target is met, not met or exceeded. The magnitude of the difference required between the result and the target to establish significance depends on the sample size (e.g., the number of students writing an exam and the proportion of students meeting standards).

#### Assessing Results Over Time

Changes over time are assessed with a two-sample Chi-square statistical test for measures based on tests of student learning or on administrative data (i.e., derived from tracking groups of students over time, such as participation rates in Language Arts provincial achievement tests). The test determines whether the difference between two proportions (e.g., base year and current year results) is significant. The calculation of Chi-square is based on the difference between what was observed and what would be expected assuming that the proportions were the same. Under a simple test of proportions, a Chi-square value of “1” represents a difference of one standard deviation, while a Chi-square value of 3.84 is significant at the five per cent level of significance.

#### Trend Lines

Although not appearing in the annual report update, trend lines are an aid to interpreting the results for measures reported in the annual report update. Trend lines augment data interpretation techniques already in use to determine the significance of changes in measure results over time.

Trend lines are used to develop an expected value for a current result given historical results. The expected value can then be compared with the actual result. In this way, trend lines provide a useful method of understanding year-to-year fluctuations and shift the focus from smaller year-to-year changes by providing information about the direction of results over the longer-term. In particular, it is of interest whether results are tracking towards the performance target for the measures that have not met targets.

Discussion of results over time for measures with at least three data points is supported by trend lines. The type of trend line used is selected based on an informed interpretation of the data series underlying the trend.

Logarithmic trend lines are appropriate for proportional data, i.e., data expressed as percentages of a whole and therefore ranging between zero and 100 per cent, such as the performance measures

in this report. A logarithmic trend line is a best-fit straight line that is most useful when the rate of change in the data increases or decreases quickly, then levels out.

A logarithmic trend line is calculated using the following formula:

$Y = c \ln(x) + b$ , where  $c$  and  $b$  are constants and  $\ln( )$  is the natural logarithm function and  $x$  is the year of the series.

**Endnote B: Methodology for Performance Measures**

Described below are the methodologies used to calculate the measures that are derived from provincial assessments of student learning and from other information about Alberta students in the Ministry of Education and Childcare's data systems.

**Definition of Alberta Student**

An Alberta student is an individual who is registered as of September 30 of the school year in a school located in Alberta, where "school" means a structured learning environment through which an education program is offered to a student by: a board (includes public, separate, francophone, Lloydminster); an operator of an independent school; an Early Childhood Services program operator; the operator of a charter school; a parent giving a home education program; the Minister. It also includes other Alberta-located educational institutions providing Early Childhood Services to Grade 12 curriculum instruction, specifically federal (First Nations schools and those operated by Corrections Canada); and provincial authorities (such as Bow Valley College and NorQuest College).

**Provincial Achievement Tests**

Students in grades 6 and 9 write provincial achievement tests annually in Language Arts and Mathematics along with Science and Social Studies. The achievement test results for grades 6 and 9 provide information on how well Alberta students are meeting provincial standards in the core academic subjects. Tests are developed and administered by teachers and educators and are based on the provincial curriculum. Results are reported in relation to the acceptable standard and standard of excellence.

A student achieving the acceptable standard in a specific grade shows an adequate understanding of the core knowledge and adequate basic skills essential to that course. A student achieving the standard of excellence consistently shows a deeper understanding of the concepts of the course by demonstrating an ability to integrate information and evaluate it from various points of view.

For each achievement test, the cut scores for the acceptable standard and the standard of excellence are set initially by a standard-setting committee of about 20 teachers selected from across the province using the modified Angoff and Bookmark standard setting procedures. These procedures use teachers' judgment to determine a minimum number of items a student must answer correctly (i.e., the cut score) to achieve each standard. In subsequent years, the cut scores for each test are adjusted through test equating. This ensures the standards remain constant even if test difficulty varies slightly from year to year. Whenever curriculum is revised, the standard-setting process is done again.

Results on provincial achievement tests are calculated and presented on the basis of the total number of students in each grade who demonstrated the standards. Given the large number of students in each grade taking English Language Arts and Mathematics in Grade 9 (more than 60,000 in an average year), differences in results from year to year of more than 0.4 percentage points, depending on the subject, are considered significant. French Language Arts, Français and Knowledge and Employability courses have higher significant difference values (1.4 to 3.0 percentage points, depending on the number of students in each course), because fewer students are in these courses and the results consequently show more variation.

Not all students write the provincial achievement tests. Achievement test results are not available for students who:

- were absent;
- were excused from writing by the superintendent because participation would be harmful to the student or the student could not respond to the test instrument; or
- wrote but whose results were withheld or invalidated.

It is possible that some of these students, under different circumstances, could have demonstrated achievement of standards on the test.

Participation rates in achievement tests are calculated by dividing the number of students in the grade who wrote the test by the sum of total enrolment in the grade plus the ungraded students who are in the corresponding year of schooling.

Provincial overall results in Language Arts and Mathematics present weighted averages based on the number of students enrolled in each course. Test results and participation are recorded and aggregated in ministry systems. Provincial, school authority and school results are available at [provincial achievement tests](#).

### Diploma Examinations

Examinations are administered in all diploma examination courses in January, June and August each year. Examinations are administered in selected courses in November and April. Provincial assessments are meant to complement but not replace day-to-day classroom assessment. Results on diploma examinations show how well Alberta students are meeting provincial expectations as outlined in the Programs of Study. Examination items are developed and standards are established by committees of teachers.

The examination design is vetted through committees of stakeholders and by a standard-setting committee of teachers. A test equating initiative has been phased in for the diploma examination program so that over time examinations are consistent and the results are comparable. The multiple-choice portion of the examinations contains a set of items common to administrations in subsequent years. By comparing the achievement of students writing in a baseline session with those writing in any subsequent administration on the common items and on the unique items, Alberta Education and Childcare is able to determine whether or not the examinations are of equal difficulty. Student scores on the subsequent examinations can then be equated back to the baseline examinations to remove any influence that differences in examination difficulty may have on student scores.

Through equating, test results for a particular course are based on an identical standard and, consequently, can be directly compared over time. As a result of implementing the equating process, diploma examination results are comparable over time as follows:

- Biology 30, English Language Arts 30-1, and English Language Arts 30-2 since 2005-06;
- Science 30 and Chemistry 30 since 2010-11;
- Social Studies 30-2 since 2011-12;
- Social Studies 30-1 since 2012-13;
- Physics 30 since 2013-14; and
- Mathematics 30-1 and 30-2 since 2016-17.

Diploma examination results are reported in relation to the acceptable standard and the standard of excellence. Results for Mathematics, Sciences and Social Studies include results for both English and French versions of the tests. Provincial overall results present weighted averages based on the numbers of students achieving standards in all diploma

examinations. Students achieving the acceptable standard demonstrate that they have met the basic requirements of the course. A mark of 50 per cent on the examination represents the acceptable standard in a diploma examination course. A mark of 80 per cent on the examination represents the standard of excellence and indicates the student has demonstrated performance significantly beyond the minimum requirements of the course. The weighting of diploma exams returned to 30 per cent on September 1, 2023 and the school-awarded mark is worth 70 per cent.

Diploma examination results are recorded and aggregated in ministry systems. Provincial, school authority and school results reports are available at [diploma exams](#).